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Sharoni et al.

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(54) **PORTULACA PLANT NAMED, 'DPORMPZO'**

(50) Latin Name: *Portulaca oleracea*
Varietal Denomination: **'DPORMPZO'**

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(73) Assignee: **Danziger "Dan" Flower Farm**

(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 52 days.

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(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./471**
CPC **A01H 6/00** (2018.05)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

USPC Plt./471
CPC A01H 6/00
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

PUBLICATIONS

Cabi Invasive Species Compendium, *Portulaca oleracea* (purslane), downloaded from <https://www.cabi.org/isc/datasheet/43609> on Dec. 12, 2021.*

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Portulaca* plant named 'DPORMPZO' is disclosed, characterized by large, vivid orange flowers, dark green foliage, and a semi-trailing habit. Plants are well-branched. The new variety is a *Portulaca*, typically produced as an ornamental plant.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Latin name of the genus and species: *Portulaca oleracea*.
Variety denomination: 'DPORMPZO'.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The new *Portulaca* cultivar is a product of a planned breeding program conducted by the inventors, Pazit Sharoni, Amir Zuker and Gavriel Danziger in Moshav Mishmar Hashiva, Israel. The objective of the breeding program was to produce useful new *Portulaca* varieties for ornamental horticultural production. The open-pollination resulting in this new variety was made during 2016.

The seed parent is the unpatented, propriety variety referred to as *Portulaca* 'PT-15-1250'. The pollen parent is unidentified. The new variety was discovered in July of 2017 by the inventor in a group of seedlings resulting from the 2016 open pollination, in a greenhouse in Moshav Mishmar Hashiva, Israel. After selection of the new variety, extensive confidential testing has been performed to determine and define the desirable characteristics of the new variety.

Asexual propagation of *Portulaca* was performed by vegetative basal cuttings at a research greenhouse in Moshav Mishmar Hashiva, Israel during the Fall of 2017.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The cultivar 'DPORMPZO' has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions. The phenotype may vary somewhat with variations in environment such as temperature, day length, and light intensity, without, however, any variance in genotype.

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The following traits have been repeatedly observed and are determined to be the unique characteristics of 'DPORMPZO'. These characteristics in combination distinguish 'DPORMPZO' as a new and distinct *Portulaca* cultivar:

1. Controlled semi-trailing habit
2. Large flowers.
3. Vivid orange flower color
4. Dark green foliage.
5. Freely branching habit

PARENT COMPARISON

Plants of 'DPORMPZO' are similar in some horticultural characteristics to the seed parent. The new variety, however, differs in the following:

1. Flowers of the new variety are vivid orange; flowers of the seed parent are dark pink.
2. Plant habit of the new variety is more controlled than that of the seed parent.
3. Flowers of the new variety are larger than those of the seed parent

Comparison with the pollen parent is unavailable, as this variety resulted from an open pollination.

COMMERCIAL COMPARISON

Plants of the new cultivar 'DPORMPZO' can be compared to the commercial variety *Portulaca* Nano 'Orange', unpatented. These varieties are similar in most horticultural characteristics;

1. This comparator has more compact and dense habit than 'DPORMPZO'.
2. The flowers of this comparator are a different shade of orange than flowers of 'DPORMPZO'.
3. Foliage color of this comparator is lighter green than foliage of 'DPORMPZO'.

Plants of the new cultivar 'DPORMPZO' can also be compared to the variety *Portulaca Pazzaz* 'Orange Flare', unpatented. These varieties are similar in most horticultural characteristics; however, 'DPORMPZO' differs in the following:

1. Foliage color of this comparator is lighter green than foliage of 'DPORMPZO'.
2. 'DPORMPZO' produces larger flowers than this comparator.
3. Plants of 'DPORMPZO' are more vigorous than plants of this comparator.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying photograph in FIG. 1 illustrates in full color a typical plant of 'DPORMPZO' at about 8 weeks of age, grown in a 13 cm pot.

FIG. 2 illustrates a closer view of a typical flower of the new variety.

The photographs were taken using conventional techniques and although colors may appear different from actual colors due to light reflectance it is as accurate as possible by conventional photographic techniques.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Mini Colour Chart 2005 except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used. The following observations and measurements describe 'DPORMPZO' plants grown outdoors in Moshav Mishmar Hashiva, Israel, under natural lighting. Measurements were taken during Spring. The growing temperature ranged from approximately 24° C. to 38° C. during the days, 12° C. to 26° C. during the nights. Measurements and numerical values represent averages of typical plant types.

Botanical classification: *Portulaca oleracea* 'DPORMPZO'.

PROPAGATION

Time to initiate rooting: Vegetative cuttings.

Root description: 10 to 12 days at approximately 24° C.

Root description: Fine, fibrous; close to Yellow-White 158C in color, freely branching.

PLANT

Growth habit: Semi-trailing.

Pot size of plant described: 19 cm.

Height: About 23 cm.

Plant spread: About 28 cm radius.

Growth rate: Medium vigor.

Branching characteristics:

Length of primary lateral branches: 28 cm.

Diameter of lateral branches: 0.6 cm.

Quantity of primary lateral branches: About 8 per 1 main stem.

Characteristics of primary lateral branches:

Diameter.—About 0.35 to 0.4 cm.

Color.—Tip Near Yellow-Green RHS 144B; Base near RHS Red-Purple 59B (Anthocyanin coloration).

Texture.—Glabrous.

Strength.—Moderately strong.

Internode length: Approximately 1.3 to 2.5 cm.

Age of plant described: Approximately 60 days from a rooted cutting.

FOLIAGE

Arrangement: Alternate, simple.

Quantity.—Approximately 15 per branch.

Average length.—3 to 4.5 cm.

Average width.—1.7 cm.

Shape of blade.—Obovate.

Apex.—Rounded, slightly mucronate.

Base.—Cuneate.

Margin.—Entire.

Texture of top surface.—Smooth.

Texture of bottom surface.—Smooth.

Pubescence.—None.

Aspect.—Straight, occurring at an angle of about 45-70°.

Color.—Young foliage upper side: Close RHS 137B.

Young foliage under side: Close to RHS 137D.

Mature foliage upper side: Close to RHS 137A.

Mature foliage under side: Close to RHS 137C.

Venation.—Indistinguishable from leaf blade.

Petiole.—Length: About 1.2 mm. Diameter: About 1 mm. Color: Near RHS Yellow-Green 144B. Texture: Smooth, glabrous.

FLOWER

Natural flowering season: Spring to Fall in Israel.

Days to flowering from rooted cutting: About 4 weeks to the first flowers.

Inflorescence and flower type and habit: Single flower, abundant flowering.

Rate of flower opening: About 3 days from bud to fully opened flower.

Flower longevity on plant: About 1 day.

Persistent or self-cleaning: Self-Cleaning.

Bud:

Shape.—Ovoid.

Length.—1 to 1.2 cm.

Diameter.—0.7 cm.

Color.—Near RHS Yellow-Green 144B; tip anthocyanin flushed near Red-Purple 59B.

Flower size:

Diameter.—About 5.3 cm.

Depth.—About 2 cm.

Corolla/petals:

Arrangement.—5 petals merged/fused at the base.

Length.—2.6 cm.

Width.—2.4 cm.

Quantity.—5 petals.

Texture.—Smooth, glabrous.

Apex.—Emarginate to retuse.

Shape.—Obovate with a cuneate base.

Margin.—Entire.

Aspect.—Mostly flat, upper margin slightly rolled down.

Color:

When opening:

Upper surface.—RHS Orange-Red N30B. Base near Yellow 13A. Veins through base, near N30B.

Lower surface.—RHS Orange-Red N30B. Faint basal coloration near Yellow 12C. 5

Fully opened:

Upper surface.—RHS Orange-Red 33A. Base near Yellow 13A.

Lower surface.—RHS Orange-Red 33B. Small area of yellow coloration at base, near Yellow 12B. 10

Calyx/sepal:

Quantity per flower.—2 Sepals per flower.

Shape.—Fused into a tubular calyx. Pointed apex. 15

Length.—0.9 cm to 1 cm.

Width.—0.8 cm to 1 cm.

Apex.—Acute.

Base.—Fused.

Margin.—Entire.

Texture.—Glabrous.

Color.—Upper Surface: RHS Yellow-Green 144B, anthocyanin flushed Red-Purple 59C. Lower Surface: Near RHS Yellow-Green 144B.

Peduncle: None.

Fragrance: None detected.

REPRODUCTIVE ORGANS

Androecium:

Stamens:

Number.—Many, about 60.

Filament length.—Approximately 0.6 cm.

Anthers:

Shape.—Oval.

Length.—About 0.8 mm.

Color.—Near RHS Yellow-Orange 17B.

Pollen.—Color: RHS Yellow-Orange 17A. Quantity: Abundant.

Gynoecium:

Pistil:

Number.—1.

Length.—1 cm.

Style.—Length: 0.8 cm. Color: Base near RHS Yellow 9B.

Stigma.—Shape: Six branched stigma. Color: Near RHS Yellow 9A. Ovary Color: Near RHS Yellow-Green 144B.

OTHER CHARACTERISTICS

Seeds and fruits: Seeds are minute and dark grey with a circular shape. 20

Disease/pest resistance: Neither resistance nor susceptibility observed. *Portulaca* is not typically susceptible to many diseases and pests. The most common diseases being typical root rots from over watering, or black stem, *Dichotomophthora portulaca*. The most common pest of *Portulaca* is Aphid. 25

Temperature tolerance: Will not tolerate temperatures below 7° C. High temperature tolerance near 40° C.

What is claimed is:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Portulaca* plant named 'DPORMPZO' as herein illustrated and described. 30

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FIG. 1



FIG. 2